Survey and interview question check

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AP RESEARCH · CHECK YOUR INSTRUMENT BEFORE MR. PORTELA REVIEWS IT

STUDENT CODE _____ PERIOD _____ DATE _____

College Board's rule. "The teacher must review any surveys, interview questions, questionnaires, or other interventions to be used in a project." Bring a clean draft. This sheet is about the questions you ask participants. It never changes your research question.

Every question

☐	**One idea.** It asks about one thing. A question joined by "and" is two questions.
☐	**Plain words.** A ninth grader would understand it the first time.
☐	**No push.** The wording does not point toward the answer I hope for.
☐	**Choices fit.** Every person can find their answer, and no two choices overlap.
☐	**Skippable.** A person can leave it blank or choose "prefer not to say."
☐	**Earns its place.** I know which part of my analysis will use the answer.

The whole instrument

☐	**Time.** I timed it on one person. It took _____ minutes, and my form says so.
☐	**No identities.** It does not ask for a name or anything that points to one person.
☐	**Minimal risk.** Nothing in it could embarrass, upset, or expose a participant.
☐	**Order.** Easy questions first. Anything harder comes later.
☐	**Interviews.** Questions are open, and my follow-ups are neutral: "Tell me more about that."
☐	**Tried once.** One person tried it and told me what confused them.

After my trial run: what I cut or changed, and why

Number of questions in the final version, and the minutes it takes

Attach the final instrument to item 9 of your Inquiry Proposal Form. No question goes to a participant before it is approved.